

# Aakashsha Jain

Department of Economics, Iowa State University  
173 Heady Hall, 518 Farm House Lane, Ames, IA 50011, USA  
[aakashsha@iastate.edu](mailto:aakashsha@iastate.edu) · [aakashshajain.com](http://aakashshajain.com) · [Google Scholar](#) · [LinkedIn](#)

## EDUCATION

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Ph.D. in Economics, Iowa State University, USA                                                              | May 2027 (expected) |
| M.Sc. in Economics, Shiv Nadar University, India                                                            | 2020                |
| B.Sc. in Economics, University of Calcutta, India<br>(Minor: Mathematics & Statistics; First-Class Honours) | 2017                |

## FIELDS OF INTEREST

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Labor Economics, Agricultural Labor, Development Economics, Rural Development, Economics of Education, Migration, Applied Microeconomics

## JOB MARKET PAPER

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[“The Rise of H-2A: Causal Evidence on Guestworker Substitution for Settled Farm Labor”](#)  
*solo-authored*

## PUBLICATIONS

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Manternach, R., **Jain, A.**, Orazem, P.F., & Soborowicz, L. (2025). [“Are College Towns Really Recession Proof?”](#) *Growth and Change*, 56(4): e70064.

**Jain, A.**, Montenegro, C., & Orazem, P.F. (forthcoming, 2026). “Youth Labor Markets in High- and Low-Income Countries.” In K. Leicht (Ed.), *Oxford University Handbook on the 21st Century Economy*. Oxford University Press.

## WORKING PAPERS AND WORKS IN PROGRESS

- 
- “Returns to Farming Among Iowa State Alumni” (with I. Cho and P.F. Orazem)
  - [“College Wage Premiums in India: Trends and Spatial Decomposition, 1987–2012”](#) (solo-authored)
  - [“An Overview of the 2024 Iowa State University Alumni Survey”](#) (with A. Andrade, J. Eyles, K. Kimle, P.F. Orazem, and R. Unal)
  - “Does Broadband Close the Rural Education Gap?” (with L. Han and J.V. Winters)
  - “Firm Entry and Serial Entrepreneurship Among Iowa State Alumni” (with D. Lin and P.F. Orazem)

## POLICY REPORTS

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- **Jain, A.**, Lin, D., & Orazem, P.F. (forthcoming, Nov 2026). “Graduating in a Downturn: Business Cycles and Entrepreneurship Among Iowa State Graduates.” *Agricultural Policy Review*.
  - **Jain, A.**, & Chandio, R. (forthcoming, Nov 2026). “Who Hires H-2A Workers in Iowa, and for What?” *Agricultural Policy Review*.
  - Crespi, G., & **Jain, A.** (2026). [“Where Do They Go? Migration Patterns of Iowa State University Alumni.”](#) *Agricultural Policy Review*. Covered by *Axios Des Moines*.
  - Andrade, A., Eyles, J., **Jain, A.**, Kimle, K., Orazem, P.F., & Unal, R. (2025). [“How a Land Grant College Affects Business and Job Creation.”](#) *Agricultural Policy Review*.

## CONFERENCES AND PRESENTATIONS

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|                                                                                    |          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Southern Economic Association (SEA) Annual Meeting, Houston, TX (job market paper) | Nov 2026 |
| Agricultural & Applied Economics Association (AAEA) South Asia Section             |          |
| Graduate Student Symposium (job market paper)                                      | Oct 2026 |
| USDA Agricultural Marketing Service, FAME 2.0 Release Webinar (invited speaker)    | Oct 2026 |

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| AAEA Annual Meeting, Kansas City, MO (job market paper; Data Visualization Challenge) | Jul 2026 |
| Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL                             | Mar 2025 |

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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| Selected Paper (\$200 award), AAEA South Asia Section Graduate Student Symposium                                                       | 2026 |
| First Place, USDA Agricultural Marketing Service and AAEA Local Food Economics Data Visualization Challenge (with A. Basha and H. Lee) | 2026 |

- \$1,200 first-place team prize and \$1,200 in AAEA travel support

## TEACHING

|                                                                             |                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Instructor of Record, ECON 3530: Money, Banking, and Financial Institutions | Spring 2025             |
| Teaching Assistant, Iowa State University                                   | Fall 2022 – Spring 2026 |

- ECON 1010: Principles of Microeconomics; ECON 1020: Principles of Macroeconomics; ECON 2070: Quantitative Methods in Economic Analysis I; ECON 3530: Money, Banking, and Financial Institutions

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|--------------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| Teaching Assistant, Shiv Nadar University, India | Fall 2018 – Spring 2021 |
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- Econometrics (graduate course); Logic and Scientific Methods (undergraduate course)

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Research Assistant, Department of Economics, Iowa State University | Spring 2024 – Present |
| Research Assistant, Indian School of Business, Hyderabad, India    | Summer 2022           |
| Research Assistant, IFMR LEAD (development research center), India | Aug 2021 – Mar 2022   |
| Research Assistant, King's College London (project based in India) | Jun 2020 – Jul 2021   |

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

**Referee:** *Growth and Change*; *Journal of Development Effectiveness*

**Discussant:** SEA Annual Meeting (2026); AAEA South Asia Section Graduate Student Symposium (2026); Midwest Economics Association Annual Meeting (2025)

**Session Moderator:** AAEA Annual Meeting (2026)

**University:** Elected Chair, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences, and Senator, Department of Economics, Graduate & Professional Student Senate (2023 – 2024)

## SKILLS

**Software:** Stata, Python,  $\text{\LaTeX}$

**Restricted Data:** Special Sworn Status, U.S. Census Bureau; Federal Statistical Research Data Center project No. 3044 (restricted American Community Survey and Numident microdata)

**Outside Economics:** Machine Learning: A Signal Processing Perspective (EE 425)

**Languages:** English (fluent), Hindi (native)

## REFERENCES

**Dr. John V. Winters**  
Co-Major Advisor  
Professor  
Iowa State University  
[winters1@iastate.edu](mailto:winters1@iastate.edu)  
460B Heady Hall  
Ames, IA 50011  
515-294-6263

**Dr. Peter F. Orazem**  
Co-Major Advisor  
University Professor Emeritus  
Interim Department Chair  
Iowa State University  
[pfo@iastate.edu](mailto:pfo@iastate.edu)  
267 Heady Hall  
Ames, IA 50011  
515-294-8656

**Dr. Amani Elobeid**  
Teaching Professor  
Iowa State University  
[amani@iastate.edu](mailto:amani@iastate.edu)  
166D Heady Hall  
Ames, IA 50011  
515-294-8122